Bounded or boundaryless? An empirical investigation of career boundaries and boundary crossing

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作者：Ricardo Rodrigues、David Guest 和 Alexandra Budjanovcanin
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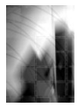
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Article

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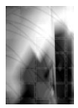
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Abstract
The article argues that the long-running debate between organizationally bounded and boundaryless careers has been too narrow and neglects the variety and distinctive characteristics of career boundaries. Drawing on boundary theory, it investigates the main career-relevant domains and boundaries, and the motivations and structural conditions that influence boundary crossing or having a career within a specific domain among a sample of professional pharmacists. The qualitative study shows that careers are enacted within a number of relevant domains and are shaped by a range of boundaries such that boundarylessness and embeddedness are co-existing career dimensions. It also reveals how even within a professional population careers are embedded within diverse social and cultural contexts that impose differing constraints on career mobility. The article therefore provides a fuller, more nuanced understanding of career boundaries and contemporary careers.

Keywords
boundaryless career, career boundary, career domain

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文章

有界或無界？關於職業邊界與邊界跨越的實證研究

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摘要
本文論述，長期以來關於「組織內界線」與「無界線職業」的辯論過於狹窄，忽視了職業界線的多元性與獨特特徵。本文藉助邊界理論，探討主要與職業相關的領域與界線，以及影響專業藥師在特定領域內進行界線跨越或發展職業的動機與結構條件。定性研究顯示，職業是在多個相關領域中實踐的，並受多種界線所塑造，使得「無界線性」與「嵌入性」成為並存的職業維度。研究亦揭示，即使在專業群體中，職業仍深植於多樣化的社會與文化脈絡之中，這些脈絡對職業流動施加不同的限制。因此，本文提供了對職業界線與當代職業更為完整、細緻的理解。

Key字
無界職業生涯、職業邊界、職業領域

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Introduction

Two decades have passed since the boundaryless career was proposed as an alternative inter-organizational lens to capture the nature of contemporary careers (Arthur, 1994). The concept has broadened research on careers and career-related topics by identifying how factors such as the interface between work and life (Kossek and Lautsch, 2012), embeddedness within occupations (Arthur and Rousseau, 1996) and subjective views of success (Arthur et al., 2005) help to shape careers and work-related identity. While the boundaryless career concept has generated considerable interest, critics have argued that the idea of boundarylessness presents a number of important conceptual and operational limitations (Cohen and Mallon, 1999; Inkson et al., 2012) and shown that the empirical basis for an increase in inter-organizational career mobility is modest (Rodrigues and Guest, 2010). Part of the problem is that the boundaryless career, like the previously dominant organizational career model, is basically a metaphor aiming to highlight trends in contemporary careers rather than a fully developed theory. While metaphors provide a useful lens to describe and develop insights about social phenomena, they are also incomplete and simplified explanations of reality (Inkson, 2006). To progress careers research we need to go beyond the duality between bounded and boundaryless careers, or traditional intra-organizational career perspectives and the more contemporary inter-organizational lens, and address the complexity of boundaries in contemporary careers.

This article argues that the conceptual and operational limitations of the boundaryless career concept reside, to a significant extent, in the way its proponents envisage the characteristics and the range of career boundaries. Despite calls to bring boundaries to the forefront of the careers debate (Gunz et al., 2007; Inkson et al., 2012), they remain neglected as a focus of empirical research. This article addresses this omission by setting out an initial conceptualization of career boundaries and career domains, identifying a research agenda and reporting a qualitative study investigating career-related boundaries and factors affecting boundary crossing. The discussion is informed by contributions from sociological literature on what has loosely been labelled boundary theory (Hernes, 2004). Boundary theory underpins major streams of sociological research such as social identity theory and systems theory and seeks to explain how boundaries are socially constructed and affect behaviour.

The article is structured as follows. First, using a review of the conceptual strengths and limitations of the boundaryless career concept as a point of departure, and informed by boundary theory, it highlights the potential benefits of investigating boundaries to more fully understand the nature of contemporary careers and identifies a number of key research questions. Second, it explores the main career-relevant domains and boundaries, the motivations to cross or to have a career within a specific boundary domain and the perceived constraints on boundary crossing among a sample of professional pharmacists. The findings indicate that people identify and subjectively construe a wide range of salient career domains and boundaries and that boundarylessness and embeddedness should be viewed as co-existing career dimensions. In addition, the findings show that people seek to manage their careers within multiple boundaries while factors such as family, gender and ethnicity can facilitate but more often constrain boundary crossing and career mobility. The article therefore goes beyond the duality between bounded and

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簡介

自無界職業概念於 1994 年（Arthur, 1994）被提出，作為捕捉當代職業本質的替代性組織間視角以來，已過去二十載。此概念透過識別工作與生活介面（Kossek 和 Lautsch, 2012）、嵌入於職業之中（Arthur 和 Rousseau, 1996）以及主觀成功觀（Arthur 等，2005）等要素如何塑造職業與工作相關身份，擴大了對職業及相關議題的研究。儘管無界職業概念引發了廣泛關注，但批評者指出，該概念在重要理論與操作層面存在若干限制（Cohen 和 Mallon, 1999; Inkson 等，2012），並顯示出組織間職業流動性增加的實證基礎相當有限（Rodrigues 和 Guest, 2010）。問題之一在於，無界職業概念與先前主導的組織內職業模型一樣，本質上是一種旨在凸顯當代職業趨勢的隱喻，而非一套完整的理論。雖然隱喻提供了描述與發展關於社會現象見解的有用視角，但它們也是對現實的不完整且簡化的解釋（Inkson, 2006）。若要推動職業研究，我們必須超越「有界」與「無界」職業的二元對立，或傳統組織內職業視角與當代組織間視角之間的對立，並應對當代職業中邊界的複雜性。

本文論述，邊界無職業（boundaryless career）概念在概念與操作層面的限制，在很大程度上源於其倡導者對該概念特徵及職業邊界範圍的構想。儘管已有呼籲將邊界置於職業討論的核心（Gunz 等，2007；Inkson 等，2012），但邊界仍未被視為實證研究的焦點。本文透過提出職業邊界與職業領域的初步概念化、釐清研究議程，並報告一項探討職業相關邊界及影響邊界跨越因素之定性研究，以補足此一缺失。本討論參考了社會學文獻中對「邊界理論」（loosely labelled boundary theory，Hernes, 2004）的貢獻。邊界理論支撐著社會學研究的主要流派，如社會認同理論與系統理論，並旨在解釋邊界如何被社會建構及其如何影響行為。

本文結構如下。首先，以邊界無際職業概念的概念性優勢與局限性的回顧作為起點，並結合邊界理論，強調探討邊界對於更完整理解當代職業本質的潛在益處，並提出若干關鍵研究問題。其次，探討主要與職業相關的領域與邊界、跨越邊界或維持在特定邊界領域內的職業動機，以及一群專業藥師所感知的邊界跨越限制。研究結果顯示，人們會識別並主觀詮釋廣泛的顯著職業領域與邊界，且邊界無際與嵌入性應視為共存的職業維度。此外，研究結果亦顯示，人們試圖在多重邊界內管理其職業生涯，而家庭、性別與族裔等因素雖可能促進邊界跨越與職業流動，但更多時候則會限制邊界跨越與職業流動。因此，本文超越了受限與無限的二元對立。

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boundaryless careers by highlighting motives for boundary crossing but also structural influences on career mobility.

Towards a new understanding of career boundaries

The boundaryless career is broadly defined as one that 'moves across the boundaries of separate employers' (Arthur, 1994: 296). The concept was proposed as a contrast to the idea of the organizational career, commonly defined as a 'sequence of promotions and other upward moves in a work-related hierarchy during the course of the person's work life' (Hall, 1976: 2). While the boundaryless career concept has made an important contribution to careers thinking it also presents a number of conceptual issues that limit its utility.

An initial limitation of construing the boundaryless career as the opposite of the organizational career is the assumption that individuals are now free to pursue their careers in a relatively unstructured environment (Inkson, 2006). The traditional career model depicts careers as unfolding mainly within single employment settings and predicates individual career success – defined by promotion, power and income – and organizational outcomes – such as employee loyalty, commitment and citizenship behaviours – on the maintenance of strong organizational boundaries. In contrast, advocates of the boundaryless career argue that boundaries no longer set a 'division between familiar and hostile territory' (Arthur and Rousseau, 1996: 372) and should instead be viewed as permeable membranes to be crossed in career behaviour.

The view that boundaries have become weak and permeable suggests that individuals navigate their careers according to their own values and motivations. This 'manifestation of [a] wider neoliberal discourse' (Roper et al., 2010: 673) is underpinned by an ideology where careers are essentially viewed as the product of individual agency. This view is also associated with the concept of the 'protean' career (Briscoe et al., 2006), which is often described alongside the boundaryless career and which argues that people increasingly manage their own careers and impose their own definitions of career success. Such a view overlooks the contribution of the longstanding sociological research tradition on careers showing how careers are to a large extent shaped by the economic, social and cultural context. For instance, there is strong evidence that career mobility is affected by the economic climate. Voluntary turnover increases during economic expansion and declines during economic contraction (Farber, 2010). There are also variable forms of instability in the labour market which seem to have a differential impact on groups of workers. Kim (2013), for instance, shows that while inter-organizational mobility has generally increased in the USA, inter-occupational mobility has declined among high skilled workers for whom professionalization has better protected against economic instability.

The importance of social structure in shaping careers is also reflected in the presence of more or less clearly defined career scripts (Dany et al., 2011) depicting expected actions, guidelines and career trajectories to follow. For example the careers of academics are often viewed as unfolding across the boundaries of different research projects and universities. However, even these seemingly agency-driven careers are shaped by sets of institutional rules that regulate access to the occupation (e.g. holding a Phd), to jobs in

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透過強調越界動機與影響職業流動的結構因素，來探討無邊界職業。

朝向對職業邊界的新理解

無界職業廣泛被定義為「跨越獨立雇主邊界」的職業（Arthur, 1994: 296）。此概念是作為與「組織職業」觀念的對比而提出的，後者通常被定義為「個人工作生涯期間，於工作相關層級中一系列晉升及其他向上流動」(Hall, 1976: 2)。儘管無界職業概念對職業理論做出了重要貢獻，但也提出若干概念性問題，限制了其實用性。

將「無界職業」視為「組織職業」的反面所面臨的初始限制，在於假設個體如今能在相對非結構化的環境中自由追求其職業發展（Inkson, 2006）。傳統職業模型將職業描繪為主要在單一僱傭情境中展開，並預設個體職業成功——定義為晉升、權力與收入——以及組織成果——如員工忠誠度、承諾與公民行為——皆取決於堅固組織邊界的維持。相反，無界職業的支持者認為，邊界不再設定「熟悉與敵對領域之間的界線」（Arthur 和 Rousseau, 1996: 372），而應被視為在職業行為中可穿越的滲透性膜。

邊界變得薄弱且滲透的觀點認為，個體是依據自身的價值觀與動機來規劃職業生涯。這種「[a] 更廣泛的新自由主義論述的體現」（Roper 等，2010: 673）建立在一種意識形態之上，該意識形態將職業生涯本質上視為個人主體性的產物。此觀點亦與「多面手」型職業生涯（protean career）的概念相關（Briscoe 等，2006），該概念常與無邊界職業生涯並行討論，主張人們越來越自主地管理自己的職業生涯，並強加自己對職業成功的定義。然而，這種觀點忽視了長期社會學職業研究傳統所貢獻的見解，即職業生涯在很大程度上是受經濟、社會及文化背景所形塑的。例如，有強有力證據顯示職業流動性受經濟氣候影響：經濟擴張期間，自願離職率上升；經濟收縮期間則下降（Farber, 2010）。此外，勞動市場中還存在多種形式的不穩定性，對不同群體工人產生差異化影響。Kim（2013）的研究指出，雖然美國組織間流動性普遍增加，但高技能工人之間的職業間流動性卻有所下降，因為專業化對他們提供了較好的保護，使其免受經濟不穩定的衝擊。

社會結構在塑造職業生涯方面的影響，也體現在存在更多或較少明確界定的職業劇本（Dany 等，2011），這些劇本描繪了預期行為、指導原則以及應遵循的職業軌道。例如，學者的職業生涯常被視為跨越不同研究計畫與大學的邊界而展開。然而，即使是看似由個人主體性驅動的職業生涯，也受一組組制度規則的形塑，這些規則規範了進入該職業（例如持有博士學位）以及進入工作的途徑。

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leading institutions (e.g. publishing in top journals) and to promotion (e.g. holding a track record of research funding). Career scripts are particularly strong among professionals for whom possible career trajectories and rules to attain desired career outcomes are broadly shaped from the moment they join a professional body.

Issues of gender, age, ethnicity and family also strongly influence people's perceptions of and motivations for crossing career boundaries. Elchardus and Smits (2008) reported how preferences for career mobility are shaped by life stage. In their study with nearly 5000 Belgian workers, they found that as people age their preference for career stability, and particularly for a career that unfolds within the boundaries of an occupation or an organization, increases. A vast stream of sociological literature highlights how women and ethnic minorities are often at a disadvantage accessing career opportunities (Kirton, 2009). In a study on the career motivations of female doctors in the Netherlands, Pas et al. (2011) showed that a supportive home–work culture in the workplace and women's perceptions of motherhood are core mediators explaining gender imbalance in top organizational positions. Interesting cultural nuances have also been highlighted by researchers. For instance, Greenman (2011) showed that US-born Asian American women have higher earnings than women from any other ethnic background, partly because they tend to stay in work after motherhood. Family relationships are another important factor influencing people's perceptions about the desirability and the feasibility of crossing specific career boundaries. This applies, for example, in the case of familial entrepreneurship which is often passed on from one generation to the next (Bruin and Lewis, 2004), but also in the case of dual-earner couples, where the career of the man is often prioritized (Pixley, 2008).

A further limitation of construing the boundaryless career as 'the antonym of the "bounded" or "organizational" career' (Arthur, 1994: 296) is the assumption that careers are mainly constrained or enabled by organizational boundaries (Inkson, 2006). The primacy ascribed to the organizational domain is embedded in Arthur's (1994) original conceptualization of the boundaryless career and in Briscoe et al.'s (2006) operationalization of the metaphor. In a more recent elaboration of the concept Sullivan and Arthur highlighted the interplay between the objective and subjective aspects of careers, arguing that a boundaryless career is 'one that involves physical and/or psychological career mobility' (2006: 22). They also acknowledged that boundarylessness may involve mobility across a range of career-relevant boundaries such as occupation or country. Their contribution, however, raises additional concerns. First, it is not clear how psychological career mobility, which in Sullivan and Arthur's (2006) view may potentially be coupled with physical career stability, differs from the stereotypical organizational or bounded career. Second, they fail to outline the key domains shaping careers and to discuss the motivations for crossing boundaries within specific domains as well as boundary conditions facilitating or hindering career mobility. These omissions provide the core focus of the qualitative study reported in this article.

An initial task is to clarify the notion of career boundary. Boundaries are 'physical, temporal, emotional, cognitive, and/or relational limits that define entities as separate from one another' (Ashforth et al., 2000: 474). These entities exist within domains. Domains therefore comprise sets of homogenous elements which are perceived to belong to a category. For example, organizations constitute a different category or domain to

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領先機構（例如在頂級期刊發表論文）以及晉升（例如擁有研究資金獲得的紀錄）。職業腳本在專業人士中特別顯著，這些人士一旦加入專業組織，其可能的職業發展軌跡和達成理想職業成果所需的規則便已大致成形。

性別、年齡、族裔與家庭因素也強烈影響人們對跨越職業邊界的認知與動機。Elchardus 與 Smits（2008）報告指出，職業流動的偏好會隨人生階段而改變。他們對近五千名比利時員工的研究發現，隨著年齡增長，人們對職業穩定性的偏好會增加，尤其偏好那些在特定職業或組織範圍內發展的職業。大量社會學文獻強調，女性與少數族裔在獲取職業機會方面常處於不利地位（Kirton, 2009）。一項關於荷蘭女性醫師職業動機的研究顯示，Pas 等人（2011）指出，職場中支持性的家職平衡文化與女性對母職的認知，是解釋高層組織職位性別失衡的核心中介變數。研究者也強調了有趣的文化細微差別。例如，Greenman（2011）的研究顯示，美國出生的亞裔女性收入高於任何其它族裔背景的女性，部分原因在於她們傾向於在成為母親後仍繼續工作。家庭關係也是影響人們對跨越特定職業邊界之可取性與可行性的另一重要因素。這例如適用於家族企業，常由一代傳承至下一代（Bruin 和 Lewis, 2004），也適用於雙收入家庭，其中丈夫的職業常優先考慮（Pixley, 2008）。

將無界職業視為「有界」或「組織」職業的「反義詞」（Arthur, 1994: 296）的進一步限制在於，它假設職業主要受組織邊界限制或促進（Inkson, 2006）。這種賦予組織領域優先地位的觀點，已嵌入 Arthur（1994）對無界職業的原始概念化中，以及 Briscoe 等人（2006）對該隱喻的操作化定義裡。在較近期的概念闡述中，Sullivan 與 Arthur 強調了職業客觀與主觀面向的互動，並論述無界職業是「涉及實體與/或心理職業流動」的職業（2006: 22）。他們也承認，無界性可能涉及跨越多種與職業相關的邊界，例如職業或國家。然而，他們的貢獻也引發了新的疑慮。首先，尚不清楚在 Sullivan 與 Arthur（2006）看來，可能與實體職業穩定性相結合的心理職業流動，與典型的組織或有界職業有何不同。其次，他們未能闡述塑造職業的關鍵領域，也未討論在特定領域內跨越邊界的動機，以及促進或阻礙職業流動的邊界條件。這些遺漏構成了本文所報告的定性研究的核心焦點。

首要任務是釐清「職業界線」的概念。界線是「界定實體彼此獨立的物理、時間、情感、認知及/或關係性限制」（Ashforth 等，2000：474）。這些實體存在於領域之中。因此，領域由被感知為屬於某一類別的 homogeneous 元素所組成。例如，組織構成與……不同的類別或領域。

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occupations or countries. Setting boundaries through splitting a complex reality into small pieces which are then regrouped in homogenous mental niches is an integral part of the way people make sense of the world (Zerubavel, 1991). In addition to binding elements or entities belonging to a category or domain, boundaries also help us establish differences between entities within each domain (Hernes, 2004). Social systems therefore do not exist without boundaries (Sullivan, 1999).

Building on the broadly accepted definition of a career as 'the unfolding sequence of a person's work experience over time' (Arthur and Rousseau, 1996: 6), Gunz et al. (2007) argue that a 'career boundary' separates a work from a non-work domain. While the idea of a single career boundary is potentially useful to analyse careers at a higher level of abstraction, it is of limited value for analysing careers at the individual level. Like all components of social systems, individual careers are embedded in multiple domains. However, career-related boundary crossing mostly occurs across entities within domains reflected, for example, in transitions between different organizations or occupations. Careers then unfold as individuals negotiate within these domains, perhaps crossing boundaries or remaining within boundaries either by choice or because the boundaries are viewed as impermeable or because of the potential impact of boundary crossing on other domains.

Career boundaries can also have different 'textures' (Hernes, 2004). Some boundaries are physical (e.g. working within a geographical area) or social (e.g. inclusion or exclusion in occupational communities) and are therefore more tangible. Others are more psychological (e.g. preference for working for organizations known for being socially responsible) and therefore less visible. Boundaries may also differ in terms of their salience, their permeability and their permanence. Therefore, while it may be feasible to cross the boundary between organizations this may be constrained by more salient boundaries in other domains, for example those concerning the impact of work on life outside work. Thus boundary crossing within a domain may be facilitated or constrained by its impact on other salient domains. A challenge in understanding how careers unfold is therefore to identify the most salient domains for individuals and the characteristics of relevant boundaries within these domains. This is also likely to vary according to type of worker. For example, while the occupational domain is likely to be highly salient among professionals it may not significantly affect career mobility for low skilled workers.

While there are potentially a large number of career domains and respective boundaries, the number that in practice are salient for a given occupational group has yet to be established but may be quite small. Socially acknowledged domains such as organization or occupation are likely to attract most attention and the ability to cross boundaries within these can therefore assume particular significance for career outcomes. Aspects of boundary crossing within some of these career-relevant domains, particularly the organization, but also the occupation and the work–non-work interface, have already been addressed in the literature, though often in an isolated rather than an integrated way. There is therefore a need to map out these domains and boundaries and understand how people construe and seek to manage them to pave the way for an integrated perspective on contemporary careers.

The preceding analysis suggests that the way people construe boundaries reflects their own values, preferences and motivations but is also influenced by structural constraints

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職業或國家。透過將複雜的現實分割成小片段，再將其歸類於同質的心理領域中，來設定邊界，是人們理解世界的重要方式之一（Zerubavel, 1991）。除了將屬於某一類別或領域的要素或實體連結起來，邊界也有助於我們釐清同一領域內各實體之間的差異（Hernes, 2004）。因此，社會系統若無邊界則無法存在（Sullivan, 1999）。

基於廣為接受的職業定義——即「個人工作經驗隨時間展開的序列」（Arthur 與 Rousseau, 1996: 6），Gunz 等人（2007）認為，「職業邊界」將工作領域與非工作領域分隔開來。雖然單一職業邊界的概念在較高抽象層次分析職業時可能具有一些用處，但在個體層次分析職業時其價值有限。如同所有社會系統組成要素，個體職業皆嵌入於多個領域之中。然而，與職業相關的邊界跨越主要發生於領域內的實體之間，例如反映在轉換至不同組織或職業之間。接著，職業隨著個體在這些領域中進行協商而展開，或許會跨越邊界，也可能選擇留在邊界內；這可能是出於主動選擇，或是因為邊界被視為不可穿透，或是因為邊界跨越對其他領域可能產生的影響。

職業邊界也可能具有不同的「質感」（Hernes, 2004）。某些邊界是物理性的（例如在特定地理區域內工作）或社會性的（例如在職業群體中的納入或排斥），因此更具體可感。其他邊界則更具心理性（例如偏好為以社會責任聞名的組織工作），因而較不顯眼。邊界也可能在顯著性、可滲透性與持久性方面存在差異。因此，雖然跨越組織間的邊界或許可行，但這可能受到其他領域中更具顯著性的邊界所限制，例如那些關聯工作對非工作生活影響的邊界。因此，同一領域內的邊界跨越可能受到其對其他顯著領域影響的促進或限制。理解職業如何展開的一大挑戰，在於識別個體最具顯著性的領域，以及這些領域內相關邊界的特徵。這也可能因工作者類型而異。例如，雖然職業領域對專業人士而言可能極具顯著性，但未必對低技能工作者的職業流動性產生顯著影響。

雖然潛在的職業領域及其邊界數量可能相當龐大，但在實務上對特定職業群體而言具有顯著意義的領域數量尚未確立，但可能相當有限。社會上被認可的領域，如組織或職業，很可能吸引最多的關注，因此，在這些領域內跨越邊界的能力對職業成果可能具有特別重要的意義。關於某些與職業相關的領域中邊界跨越的面向，特別是組織，也包括職業以及工作與非工作介面，已在文獻中有所探討，但往往是以孤立而非整合的方式進行。因此，有必要繪製這些領域與邊界的圖景，並理解人們如何詮釋與試圖管理它們，以為建立當代職業的整合觀點鋪平道路。

前述分析表明，人們對邊界的詮釋反映了其自身的價值觀、偏好與動機，但也受到結構性條件的影響。

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imposed by the broader cultural, social and economic environment; and in understanding the significance of boundaries, the interplay between these needs to be explored. In moving beyond the duality between bounded and boundaryless careers, this article investigates the key domains and boundaries shaping careers, explores the motives underpinning boundary crossing within specific domains and the boundary conditions facilitating or hindering desired patterns of career mobility. These issues are explored in a qualitative study of professional pharmacists in the UK.

Method

Since this is an exploratory study designed to identify the range of career-relevant domains and boundaries and of key boundary crossing motivations and conditions, a decision was taken to use semi-structured interviews as these allow the exploration of a range of pre-defined themes and freedom to cover additional related topics.

Participants

The study utilized in-depth semi-structured interviews with 37 UK pharmacists. Pharmacists provide a highly relevant population for several reasons. First, following five years of education and training, there are a variety of career paths that can be pursued. A majority enter the private retail sector, working either with large chains such as Boots or in medium and small chains. In some cases, they will become self-employed owners of chemist shops. The second largest group enter the national health service (NHS), mainly working in hospitals with a smaller proportion attached to primary care. There are two smaller groups working in academia and industrial organizations and a few employed in various branches of government. It is possible to move across sectors and for many pharmacists there is the potential choice between retaining their primary professional activity or moving into management. Second, until recently, there was a longstanding shortage of pharmacists, potentially affording choice over career path. One consequence is that there is a high level of employment flexibility both in terms of hours worked and type of contract. A study by Guest et al. (2006) found that 46 per cent worked on atypical contracts including 24 per cent who had multiple jobs, often across sectors, 38 per cent who worked part-time and 11 per cent who had temporary contracts. Finally, the pharmacy population has been rapidly changing with an influx of women and ethnic minorities. The pharmacy workforce has been extensively studied by Hassell and colleagues (see, for example, Shann and Hassell, 2006) who confirm this general picture of a highly flexible workforce but also of a workforce in flux. Pharmacists, therefore, provide a useful sample because of the varied choices available within the profession, the labour market circumstances that provide the opportunity to exercise choice of career path, but also the increasing proportion of pharmacists whose careers may be partly shaped by factors such as gender and ethnicity.

Pharmacists were initially accessed through their professional body which facilitated contacts with subjects across a range of pharmacy sectors and subsequently through a snowball approach. To reflect the changing demographic characteristics of the profession in the UK, the sampling strategy ensured that people from both genders, different

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由更廣泛的文化、社會與經濟環境所塑造；而在理解邊界之重要性時，需探討這些需求之間的互動。本文旨在超越「有界」與「無界」職業生涯的二元對立，調查塑造職業生涯的關鍵領域與邊界，探討特定領域中跨越邊界所依據的動機，以及促進或阻礙期望職業流動模式的邊界條件。本研究透過對英國專業藥師的質性研究，探討上述議題。

方法

由於本研究為探索性研究，旨在釐清與職業發展相關領域及其邊界範圍，以及關鍵邊界跨越的動機與條件，因此決定採用半結構式訪談，因為此方法既能探討預先定義的主題範圍，亦能容許涵蓋其他相關議題。

參與者

本研究對 37 名英國藥師進行了深入的半結構式訪談。藥師之所以成為一個極具相關性的群體，原因如下。首先，經過五年教育與培訓後，藥師可選擇多種職業發展途徑。大多數人進入私人零售業，或在大型連鎖藥房（如 Boots）工作，或在中小型連鎖藥房工作。在部分情況下，他們會成為獨立經營藥房的業主。第二大群體進入國家衛生服務（NHS），主要在醫院工作，其中較小比例從事初級保健工作。另有兩群較小規模的藥師在學術機構與工業組織工作，少數人則在政府各部門受僱。藥師可在不同行業間轉換，對許多藥師而言，存在保留其主要專業活動或轉向管理職位的選擇可能。其次，直到最近，藥師長期面臨短缺，這在一定程度上賦予了他們在職業發展途徑上的選擇權。其後果之一是，藥師在工時與合約類型方面具有較高的就業彈性。Guest 等人（2006）的研究發現，46% 的藥師從事非典型合約工作，其中包括 24% 同時擁有多份工作（常跨行業）、38% 從事兼職工作，以及 11% 擁有臨時合約。最後，藥房群體正迅速變化，女性與少數族裔人數顯著增加。Hassell 及其同事（見例如 Shann 和 Hassell, 2006）對藥房工作力量進行了廣泛研究，他們確認了這一整體圖景：即工作力量具有高度彈性，同時處於動態變化之中。因此，藥師提供了一個有用的樣本，原因在於該專業內提供的多樣化選擇、勞動市場環境所提供的職業發展途徑選擇機會，以及藥師群體中職業發展可能部分受性別與種族等因素影響的比例日益增加。

藥師最初透過其專業組織接觸，該組織協助與不同藥房領域的受試者建立聯繫，隨後則採用滾雪球法。為反映英國該專業界人口統計特徵的變化，採樣策略確保涵蓋不同性別及不同

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Table 1. Demographic details of research participants.

Gender	Total	Ethnic group		Age group			Sector			
		White	Non-White	<39	40–49	50+	Community	Hospital	Other – pharmacy	Other – non-pharmacy
Men	9	8	1	0	4	5	2	3	3	1
Women	28	6	22	15	9	4	3	15	10	0
Total	37	14	23	15	13	9	5	18	13	1

ethnic backgrounds, age cohorts and who worked in different sectors were included. The sample for this study reflects the growing diversity in the population even though no claims can be made about representativeness (see Table 1 for information about research participants).

Data collection

Interviews were conducted by two authors of this article and focused on two key areas. First, participants were asked about their career history and key career transitions to identify career-relevant boundaries and domains (e.g. what was your first/second/third job?). Second, the interview explored people's motivation to cross a boundary or to seek a career within a specific domain and factors facilitating or inhibiting career transitions (e.g. what are you looking for in your career? Why did you take this job/change jobs/organization/occupation?). Participants were informed about the study's aims and were asked to sign a consent form. Confidentiality was assured and interviews were recorded and fully transcribed. Interviews lasted on average 90 minutes. The data were analysed and indexed into relevant themes using the software package NVivo.

Data analysis

The data analysis focused on the two areas described above and followed a thematic analysis approach (Ritchie et al., 2003). First, two authors have jointly identified all the instances in which participants referred to career domains and boundaries. Five categories were inductively identified and considered to represent the key career-bounded domains acknowledged by participants. The excerpts were then independently indexed into each category. Meetings were subsequently held to compare the coding of the data. Where disagreement existed a discussion was held until consensus was reached.

Second, the authors explored motivations to cross or to have a career within each bounded domain identified as well as salient boundary crossing conditions. To assist in this task, two categories – motivations for boundary crossing and motivations for staying within the boundary – were created for each career boundary. An additional category was created for each boundary domain to capture key boundary crossing conditions identified by participants. Both authors began by jointly identifying all the instances in which participants referred to the underlying reasons for crossing a boundary or having a career within the bounded domain. The data were independently

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表 1。研究參與者的人口統計資料。

性別	總體族群			年齡層			區域			
		白色非 - 白色		<39	40–49	50+	社區醫院其他 – 藥房			其他 – 非藥房
Men	9	8	1	0	4	5	2	3	3	1
女性 28		6	22	15	9	4	3	15	10	0
總計	37	14	23	15	13	9	5	18	13	1

納入不同族裔背景、年齡層及不同行業的受試者。本研究的樣本反映了人口日益多元的趨勢，儘管無法就其代表性做出任何主張（有關研究參與者的資訊請見表 1）。

資料收集

本研究由本文兩位作者進行訪談，並聚焦於兩個關鍵領域。首先，受訪者被要求談論其職業經歷與關鍵職業轉折，以識別與職業相關的界線與領域（例如：您的第一份/第二份/第三份工作為何？）。其次，訪談探討人們跨越界線或尋求特定領域職業的動機，以及促進或阻礙職業轉折的因素（例如：您在職業生涯中尋找什麼？為何接受這份工作/換工作/加入該組織/從事該職業？）。受訪者已被告知本研究目的，並被要求簽署同意書。研究已確保保密性，訪談過程已錄音並完整轉錄。平均每次訪談時長約 90 分鐘。資料經分析後，使用 NVivo 軟體包歸檔至相關主題。

資料分析

資料分析聚焦於上述兩個領域，並採用主題分析法（Ritchie 等，2003）。首先，兩位作者共同識別出所有參與者提及職業領域與邊界的案例。透過歸納法，確立了五個類別，並認為這些類別代表了參與者所認可的關鍵職業界域。接著，這些引文被獨立歸類至各該類別。隨後舉行會議，比對資料編碼結果。對於存在分歧之處，則持續討論直至達成共識。

其次，作者探討了每個被界定為邊界跨越或在此領域內發展職業的邊界領域中的動機，以及顯著的邊界跨越條件。為了協助完成此任務，針對每個職業邊界，建立了兩類動機：邊界跨越的動機與留在邊界內的動機。此外，為每個邊界領域額外建立了一類，以捕捉參與者所識別出的關鍵邊界跨越條件。兩位作者首先共同識別出所有參與者提及跨越邊界或在該受限領域內發展職業之根本原因的事例。資料則由獨立人員進行…

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indexed into the appropriate category and any disagreements were discussed until consensus was reached.

Findings

The findings are organized around the core issues that form the focus of the study, namely the range of domains and boundaries people identify as relevant career shapers and the motivations for boundary crossing and boundary crossing conditions.

Five clear and consistently mentioned domains and associated boundaries emerged from the data analysis: occupation; non-work; organization; sector; and geography.

Occupational domains and boundaries

All participants identified the occupational domain as a core career shaper and therefore acknowledged a particularly salient boundary between the pharmacy profession and other occupational domains. The motivation to have a career within the occupational domain of pharmacy was associated with two factors. The first was a strong occupational identification. Eighteen participants talked about their motivation to use and develop their specialist skills to a high level of competence and to be viewed as experts in the field. One participant, for instance, described how she was positively influenced by a mentor who inspired her to develop her skills:

> When I was at [Hospital] I was very inspired by the clinical pharmacist who trained me and my ambition was to do a master's degree and to be like him and be very involved clinically with the patients and training other pharmacists. (Woman in her 40s)

The second reason was the desire to make a significant contribution to society. Ten participants reported that the pharmacy profession allowed them to serve patients and contribute to the community and emphasized that this was a strong motivator to stay in the profession: 'I'm patient focused really. What keeps me going, what I love about my job is that I'm helping a patient' (Woman in her 30s).

Only five participants had, at some point, engaged in inter-occupational career transitions. The motivation to cross the occupational boundary was associated with two factors. The first, mentioned by three participants, was the desire to pursue different career interests. The second, mentioned by two participants, was regret about the decision to enter the pharmacy profession:

> I decided that I want to retrain in a completely different field […] so I'm studying archaeology and I hope to become a field archaeologist. (Man in his 40s)

> At a certain point I found out I'm actually not a clinical person. I was working at a hospital and I thought 'well I can do it but it's not really me'. (Woman in her 40s)

Most participants acknowledged two relevant factors severely inhibiting occupational boundary crossing. First, 24 participants described how the lengthy investment developing

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發現

研究結果圍繞構成研究焦點的核心議題進行組織，即人們所認定為相關職業塑造者的領域範圍與邊界，以及邊界跨越的動機與邊界跨越條件。

資料分析中出現五個清晰且一致被提及的領域及其相關邊界：職業；非工作；組織；部門；以及地理。

職業領域與界線

所有參與者均將職業領域視為塑造職業生涯的核心因素，因而特別意識到藥學專業與其他職業領域之間明顯的界線。在藥學職業領域發展職業生涯的動機與兩個因素相關。第一個因素是強烈的職業認同。十八位參與者談到他們動機在於將專長技能發展至高度專業水準，並被視為該領域的專家。其中一位參與者便描述了 mentor 如何正面影響她，激勵她發展技能：

> 當我在[醫院] 時，我深受臨床藥師的啟發，他訓練了我，我的志向是取得碩士學位，像他一樣，在臨床方面與患者密切互動，並訓練其他藥師。（一位四十多歲的女性）

第二個原因是希望對社會做出重大貢獻。十位參與者表示，藥師專業讓他們能夠服務病患並貢獻於社區，並強調這是促使他們留在該專業的重要動力：「我真的很以病患為中心。讓我持續前進、讓我熱愛這份工作的，就是我能幫助一位病患」（一位三十歲的女性）。

僅有五位參與者曾於某個階段經歷跨職業的職業轉折。跨越職業邊界的動機與兩個因素相關。第一個因素，由三位參與者提及，是希望追求不同的職業興趣。第二個因素，由兩位參與者提及，是對進入藥學專業之決定感到後悔：

> 我決定要重新受訓，進入一個完全不同的領域 […] ，所以我正在學習考古學，並希望成為一名田野考古學家。（一位四十多歲的男士）

> 在某個時刻，我發現自己其實並非臨床型人格。我在醫院工作時曾心想：「我倒是可以這麼做，但這並非我本意。」（一位四十多歲的女性）

大多數參與者承認有兩個相關因素嚴重阻礙職業邊界跨越。首先，24 名參與者描述了長期投資發展

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specialist pharmacy knowledge at university had limited their career options and referred to the high costs associated with changing occupations. As one participant explained: 'I think I will stay [in pharmacy]. I wouldn't say I love my job but […] you do so much training that it's not really worth starting from the bottom. I don't think I could go back to Uni' (Woman in her 30s).

Second, some participants described how issues of culture, gender and ethnicity influenced their decision to enter and remain in pharmacy. South Asian participants, in particular, reported that being a professional is a longstanding cultural ambition and that their families encouraged them to pursue a career in pharmacy. Asian and Middle Eastern women also talked about how a career in pharmacy is viewed as a suitable profession for a female in their communities, acting as an incentive to remain within the pharmacy occupational domain:

> I think with Asian people it's what the community says. They [family] like to say 'oh my child is an accountant, my child is a pharmacist'. That makes them look good. (Woman in her 40s)

> It's encouraged for females in the Middle East to do pharmacy. It's more of a female oriented occupation. (Woman in her 40s)

Non-work domain and the boundary between work and non-work

The second career boundary identified among pharmacists is the divide between the broad domains of work and non-work. Participants described how career and personal and family lives are often competing domains. While most people sought to maintain a clear boundary between the two domains, in practice the boundary was often highly porous, so that one domain had a significant influence over the other. The constraints imposed by non-work commitments on career choices, and vice versa, seemed to be particularly important when starting a family and having children. These constraints were experienced in different ways by men and women in this study. Men typically reported that having a family and dependent children had either not affected their career commitments or had made them worry more about job security and ensuring a reliable source of income, sometimes forcing them to work longer hours. As one participant stated:

> Ten years ago I had three young children and my aim was to make sure that I had security for myself and for them. Now my older boy is 17 and the other is 16 and I don't really worry about that. I'm not that bothered about pay now. (Man in his 50s)

In contrast, after getting married and having children, the majority of women reported experiencing strong career constraints stemming from their family demands. Ten women had crossed the boundary from work to non-work for periods between four months and three years. Eight of these transitions were due to the birth of a child and two women relocated so that their partners could benefit from a career opportunity. Women for whom work and career were viewed as salient priorities sought to minimize the impact of the non-work domain on their career decisions. For example, one participant described how

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大學的專科藥學知識限制了他們的職業選擇，並讓他們意識到轉換職業所伴隨的高昂成本。正如一位參與者所解釋：「我想我會留在[藥學]。我無法說我熱愛這份工作，但[…] 你接受了這麼多訓練，重新從頭開始實在不值得。我認為我無法再回大學了」（一位三十歲的女性）。

其次，部分參與者描述了文化、性別與種族如何影響他們選擇並留在藥學領域的決定。特別是南亞參與者表示，成為專業人士是長期以來文化上的願景，且其家人鼓勵他們投身藥學職業。亞洲與中東女性也談到，在他們的社群中，藥學職業被視為適合女性的工作，這成為她們留在藥學領域的動力：

> 我覺得在亞洲人身上，就是看社群怎麼說。他們 [family] 喜歡說「哦，我孩子是會計，我孩子是藥師」。這樣讓他們看起來很好。(40 歲女性)

> 在中東，鼓勵女性從事藥學專業。這更偏向於女性導向的職業。（四十歲女性）

非工作領域與工作與非工作之間的界線

藥師所界定的第二種職業邊界，是工作領域與非工作領域之間的界線。參與者描述道，職業生活與個人及家庭生活經常是相互競爭的領域。雖然大多數人試圖在兩者之間維持清晰的界線，但在實際操作中，這道界線往往非常模糊，以致於一個領域對另一個領域產生顯著影響。非工作承諾對職業選擇所施加的限制，以及反之亦然，在開始建立家庭及育兒時顯得尤為重要。在本研究中，男性與女性對這些限制的感受有所不同。男性通常表示，擁有家庭及受養子女並未影響其職業承諾，或使其更擔憂工作穩定性與確保穩定的收入來源，有時甚至迫使他們延長工作時間。如一位參與者所述：

> 十年前我有三個年幼的孩子，我的目標是確保自己與他們都有保障。現在我大兒子 17 歲，小兒子 16 歲，我其實不再那麼擔心了。我現在也不那麼在意薪資。（一位 50 多歲的男士）

相比之下，在結婚並育有子女後，大多數女性表示其家庭需求導致了強烈的職業限制。十位女性曾從工作轉至非工作狀態，時間介於四個月至三年不等。其中八次轉變是因應生育子女，另有兩位女性搬遷以讓伴侶能把握職業機會。對於將工作與職業視為重要優先事項的女性而言，她們試圖將非工作領域對其職業決策的影響降至最低。例如，一位參與者描述道：

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getting pregnant conflicted with her career ambitions and another one emphasized the importance of returning to work as soon as possible after maternity:

> I got pregnant and miscarried […] and when I got pregnant I thought 'Oh my goodness what have we done?' and when I miscarried I had mixed feelings about it. I was sad but equally I was quite relieved because could I really do this job and have a family? I decided not to have a family probably because I had too much to give up. (Woman in her 40s)

> Career wise having my child I knew I had to get back to work because I went to a talk about what happens to women's careers when they have children and how the trajectory flattens off. (Woman in her 50s)

In contrast, women who prioritized family over their careers seemed to be more willing to stop working and more concerned with finding work arrangements that fitted with their personal and family lives. These women often moved from full-time to part-time jobs and accepted lower-level positions in their current or in other organizations:

> I went back after six months, but I couldn't go back to that role [procurement]. I went back in a different guise. I dropped the on-call, I dropped the hours, etc. (Woman in her 30s)

> Obviously my priorities had changed, having a baby. I wanted to go back to work [after maternity leave] but I was on quite a high salary at the time. They said 'if you come back as a basic pharmacist, you lose one week's annual leave and you would have to slash your salary'. (Woman in her 40s)

Among a number of ethnic minority women in particular, the family and non-work domain took priority over their careers, with some stopping work altogether. One participant from an Asian background described how her partner's career became the priority after they got married. Another stated that in her group of eight close university friends she was the only woman who continued working after getting married:

> The reason probably why I haven't [taken a career opportunity] is because I got married to him here and he can't [move]. We're quite tied to London at the moment and his job's the priority […] if I get pregnant he's got to earn the money so it's wherever his job takes us. (Woman in her 40s)

> From the six girls I am the only one who is still in pharmacy doing something with my career. The two guys are still pharmacists but the girls are not! I used to say 'why are you wasting the taxpayer's money?' (Woman in her 30s)

The organizational domain and boundaries

The organization was the third relevant domain identified by participants in this study. Interviewees had changed organizations on average 4.7 times (between two and eight times) since qualifying as professional pharmacists, suggesting that this is another relatively porous boundary. The analysis identified two main motives for having a career within organizational boundaries. The first was concern about employment security and

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懷孕與她的職業目標相衝突，另一則則強調應在產後盡快重返職場：

> 我懷了 [...] ，然後流產……當我懷孕時，我心想「天哪，我們做了什麼？」；當我流產時，我心情複雜。我難過，但也同樣感到相當釋懷，因為我是否真的能從事這份工作並擁有家庭？我決定不擁有家庭，可能是因為我必須放棄太多。（一位四十多歲的女性）

> 職業方面，有了孩子後，我知道必須重返職場，因為我曾參加一場關於女性生育後職業發展軌跡如何趨於平緩的講座。（一位五十歲的女性）

相比之下，將家庭置於職業之上的女性似乎更願意停止工作，更關注尋找能與個人生活及家庭生活相配合的工作安排。這些女性常從全職轉為兼職，並接受目前或他處組織中較低層級的職位：

> 我回來了，過了六個月，但我無法回到那個角色 [採購]。我以另一種身份回來。我放下了待命，放下了工作時長等等。（一位三十多歲的女性）

> 顯然，我的優先順序已改變，因為我有了孩子。我想在產假後 [重返工作] ，但當時我的薪水還很高。他們說：「如果你以藥劑師的基本身份回來，將扣除一週的年假，而且必須大幅降低你的薪水。」（一位四十多歲的女性）

在許多少數族裔女性中，家庭與非工作領域優先於職業發展，部分人甚至完全停止工作。一位亞裔背景的女參與者表示，結婚後，她的伴侶職業成為優先事項。另一位則指出，在她八位親密大學好友中，她是唯一一位在結婚後仍繼續工作的女性：

> 我沒能 [把握職業機會] 的原因，大概是因為我在此地嫁給他，而他無法 [搬遷]。我們目前與倫敦的聯繫很緊密，他的工作優先 [...] 如果我懷孕，他必須賺取養家費用，所以無論他的工作帶我們到哪裡，我們就住哪裡。（一位四十多歲的女性）

> 在六名女生中，我是唯一仍在藥房從事與職業相關工作的人。那兩位男生仍是藥師，但女生們不是！我過去常說：「你們為何浪費納稅人的錢？」（一位三十歲的女性）

組織領域與邊界

該組織是本研究參與者所識別出的第三個相關領域。受訪者在成為專業藥師後，平均更換過 4.7 次工作單位（介於兩到八次之間），顯示這又是一個相對多孔的界線。分析識別出兩項主要動機，促使人們在組織邊界內發展職業生涯。第一項是對就業安全的擔憂，以及

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financial stability. Five participants described how they sought work in organizations that offered long-term employment prospects. The second motive, mentioned by four participants, was identification with the work environment, the values and the culture of an organization:

> We're [Organization] in a total state of change but I have a permanent contract so I'm safe from that point of view. (Man in his 40s)

> I like working in academia doing research but always linked to patients and health care because it's really great to see that what you do has an impact on services for patient care. That's why I love it here. (Woman in her 40s)

In contrast, motivation to cross organizational boundaries was associated with preference for variety and challenge at work. Six participants considered that spending a long time with an organization generated undesired routines. Their career preferences often led them to move organizations or seek temporary work assignments. For example, one participant left his organization to become a consultant to benefit from the opportunity of working in challenging projects:

> I got out, set myself up as a management consultant and the reason to do that was that I felt that I would be able to select the jobs that I wanted. I would be relatively free to move between jobs. (Man in his 50s)

Participants reported that major life events affected the desire to cross the organizational boundaries. Among men, having a family and dependent children raised concerns about ensuring regular income, preventing them from making risky career moves; or it encouraged them to seek better remunerated jobs either with their current employer or in another organization. In contrast, family obligations made women, particularly those from an ethnic minority background, more willing to cross organizational boundaries or to stop working altogether:

> I think when you are younger and you have a family and a mortgage then you cannot afford to take reckless decisions so up to a point you always have to conform in order to secure the income. (Man in his 50s)

> I am getting married, at some point I hope to have children, then if I have a career break to have children I may not want to put in the hours that I was doing before. I may find that it's easier just to become a locum and do my day's work and go home. (Woman in her 30s)

Sector domains and boundaries

Participants identified two types of sector boundary. The first, between public and private sector organizations, was crossed by 10 participants in this study. Of these, eight left the public sector/NHS for jobs in private organizations, one returned to the NHS after experience in the private sector and another moved into the NHS from a private organization. Participants seeking work in the NHS were motivated by its patient focused culture and job

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財務穩定。五位參與者描述了他們如何尋求在提供長期就業機會的組織中工作。第二個動機，由四位參與者提及，是與工作環境、組織的價值觀及文化產生認同：

> 我們是 [組織]，處於全面變革的狀態，但我有一份永約，所以從這個角度看我很安全。（一位四十多歲的男士）

> 我喜歡在學術界從事研究工作，但始終與患者和醫療保健緊密相連，因為看到自己的工作能對患者照護服務產生影響，這真的很棒。這就是我愛在這裡的原因。（一位四十多歲的女性）

相反，跨越組織邊界的動機與對工作多樣性和挑戰性的偏好相關。六位參與者認為，長期在一家組織工作會產生不想要的慣性。他們的職業偏好常促使他們轉換工作地點或尋求臨時工作任務。例如，一位參與者離開原組織以成為顧問，藉此獲得參與具有挑戰性專案的機會：

> 我辭職後，自組管理顧問公司，這樣做的原因是，我認為自己能選擇自己想做的職位，並能相對自由地在不同職位間轉換。（一位五十多歲的男士）

參與者表示，重大生活事件會影響其跨越組織邊界的意願。對於男性而言，擁有家庭及需要撫養的子女，會讓人擔心能否確保穩定的收入，避免他們做出風險性高的職業選擇；或促使他們尋求薪資較高的工作，無論是在現任雇主處還是其他組織。相對地，家庭責任讓女性，特別是來自少數族裔背景的女性，更願意跨越組織邊界，或完全停止工作：

> 我認為，當你年輕時，有家庭要養，還有房貸要還，就無法負擔冒險的決定，所以到了一定程度，你總是要順從，才能確保收入。（一位五十多歲的男士）

> 我即將結婚，未來某個時候我希望有孩子。如果為了生育而需要職業中斷，我可能就不想再投入以前那樣的工作時數。我可能會發現，直接成為臨時醫師、完成當天的工作便回家，會比較輕鬆。（一位三十多歲的女性）

區域領域與邊界

參與者辨識出兩種部門邊界類型。第一種位於公共部門與私人部門組織之間，本研究中有 10 位參與者跨越了此邊界。其中，八位離開公共部門/國家衛生服務體系（NHS）前往私人組織工作，一位在擁有私人部門經驗後重返 NHS，另一位則從私人組織轉入 NHS。尋求在 NHS 工作的參與者，是受其以患者為中心的文化與工作所吸引。

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security. Participants seeking work in the private sector highlighted its more dynamic environment:

> I am an NHS pharmacist. The NHS part is very important to me. The kind of culture in the NHS is that you get a salary but you are not allowed to make a profit because this is not a business. (Woman in her 40s)

> The remuneration is possibly not as high as you would expect in the private sector but the stability is higher and the NHS stability suits my personality. (Man in his 40s)

> In the NHS everything moves extremely slowly. Even now 10 or 15 years later they are just implementing these systems [computerized prescribing]. I did an MBA and left the NHS. (Woman in her 40s)

The second type of boundary separates different sectors within pharmacy. The evidence suggested that people working in different pharmacy sectors had different career priorities and sought different work experiences. The main motivations for working in community pharmacy and in primary care were the possibility of balancing work and life outside work and the desire to make a contribution to society. As one participant argued, in community pharmacy 'you can always get locums so therefore you don't have to be there as long as you make sure the systems are in place' (Man in his 60s).

People working in hospital pharmacy performed a wider variety of roles and sought opportunities to develop their specialist skills to a high level of competence. One participant chose to work in hospital pharmacy from the start of his career because 'the variety there made [him] choose even at that stage that the hospital would be [his] career' (Man in his 40s). Finally, the main motivation to work in industry was perceived to be the high income. One participant chose this sector at the beginning of her career 'basically to make a lot of money' (Woman in her 50s).

Twelve participants have crossed pharmacy sector boundaries at some point in their careers. These people mainly sought opportunities to develop new skills and expand their portfolio of work experiences, revealing that for some pharmacists this is a relatively porous boundary:

> I don't actually want to be in this role for much longer. Because I can see myself getting quite comfortable and staying here for the rest of my life. I was thinking I wanted to go into industry, one last sector I haven't actually gone to. (Man in his 50s)

The findings identified four boundary crossing factors that imposed limitations on sector mobility. The first was differences in specialist skills but also in public policy regulating work and pharmacists' role in different sectors. The boundary between hospital and community pharmacy was particularly salient. As one participant stated: 'When you read about the changes in retail or in community pharmacy it's an awful lot of work to re-train yourself for all that' (Woman in her 30s).

The second influence on sector crossing was work ethics associated with working in different sectors. In this case, participants highlighted the existence of a boundary separating industry from all other pharmacy sectors. Industry pharmacists were perceived to

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安全。尋求在私營部門工作的參與者指出其更具活力的環境：

> 我是一名英國國家衛生服務（NHS）的藥劑師。NHS 這部分對我來說非常重要。NHS 的文化是：你獲得薪資，但不被允許獲利，因為這不是商業機構。（一位四十多歲的女性）

> 薪酬可能不如您在私人部門所預期的高，但穩定性更高，而 NHS 的穩定性符合我的性格。（一位四十多歲的男士）

> 在英國國家衛生服務體系（NHS），一切進展都極其緩慢。即使過了十幾年，他們仍在逐步實施這些系統 [電腦處方]。我讀過工商管理碩士學位，然後離開了 NHS。（一位四十多歲的女性）

第二種邊界界定了藥房內部不同部門之間的差異。證據顯示，在不同藥房部門工作的人擁有不同的職業優先事項，並尋求不同的工作經驗。在社區藥房和初級保健工作的主要動機，在於能夠平衡工作與生活，以及希望為社會做出貢獻。正如一位參與者所論述，在社區藥房「總是有臨時工可以請，因此你不必一直待在那裡，只要確保系統運作正常即可」（一位六十多歲的男士）。

醫院藥房從業人員承擔了更多樣化的角色，並尋求發展專長技能至高度專業水平的機會。一位參與者從職業生涯初期便選擇在醫院藥房工作，因為「那裡的多樣性讓他[在當時階段] 就決定醫院將是[他的] 職業」（一位四十多歲的男士）。最後，進入產業部門的主要動機被認為是高薪。一位參與者從職業生涯初期便選擇該領域，「基本上是為了賺很多錢」（一位五十多歲的女士）。

十二位參與者在其職業生涯中曾跨越過藥房領域的界線。這些人主要尋求發展新技能及擴展工作經驗組合的機會，顯示對部分藥師而言，這是一條相對通透的界線：

> 我其實不想在這個職位上待太久。因為我意識到，自己可能會變得相當安於現狀，並在此度過餘生。我考慮過，想進入產業界，那是我尚未涉足的最后一个領域。（一位五十多歲的男士）

研究結果識別出四個影響部門流動性的邊界跨越因素。第一項是專科技能差異，以及不同部門中規範工作的公共政策與藥師角色的差異。醫院與社區藥房之間的界線尤為顯著。正如一位參與者所言：「當閱讀關於零售或社區藥房變革的報導時，為了適應這些變化而重新培訓自己，工作量實在太大。」（一位三十多歲的女性）

對跨部門影響的第二個因素是與在不同部門工作相關的職業道德。在此情況下，參與者指出存在一道界線，將藥業與其他所有藥房部門分隔開來。藥業藥師被認為

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be working in a context where decisions were made with the view of maximizing profit whereas other pharmacists saw themselves as delivering a valuable service for the community: 'I don't agree with a lot of the ethics in industry [pharmacy]. I know it's inevitable but making money from other people's health has never been the biggest attraction for me' (Woman in her 30s).

The salience of specific pharmacy sectors was also influenced by family and issues of gender and ethnicity. Small pharmacy businesses are often passed from generation to generation, shaping decisions to become community pharmacists. One participant reported how having a pharmacy business in the family shaped her career preferences:

> My parents used to own a [pharmacy] shop. I always liked the retail sector as a result of that. I liked talking to patients and making profits. I think that community was always the way that I was going to go. I knew that from the outset. (Woman in her 40s)

Family pressures to work in community pharmacy were also reported by many female participants, particularly those from an Asian and Middle Eastern background. They described how community pharmacy allowed women in their culture the opportunity to reconcile work with important family commitments: 'I've actually been encouraged [by family] to work in the community. It's easier for a girl to work in community pharmacy, come home in the evening, and take care of the kids' (Woman in her 40s).

The final boundary crossing factor was constraints in accessing jobs in specific sectors, especially in industry and hospital pharmacy. This was particularly important after the pre-registration stage:

> It was quite competitive to get into industry, so I went for hospital. (Woman in her 30s)

> I tried to get into hospital but it's very difficult so I did it [pre-registration] in a little independent shop which is good experience but very different to working in hospital. (Woman in her 30s)

Geographical domains and boundaries

The final influential career boundary identified by participants was geography. Eight participants in this study relocated to progress their or their partners' careers. The motivation to cross geographical boundaries was associated either with career advancement or the desire to live in another location:

> I came here [from Wales to England] because I wanted to do more research and it was evident that I wouldn't have time with all the management responsibilities I had. (Woman in her 40s)

> I sort of changed career pathways because I really wanted to go back to New Zealand so I thought 'let's give hospital a try'. (Woman in her 40s)

Two participants reported a strong motivation to have a career within clear geographical boundaries. This largely stemmed from preference for a lifestyle associated with living in a particular area. The first participant applied for a job in a hospital in London because she 'always wanted to live [t]here' (Woman in her 30s). The second participant

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在一個以最大化利潤為目標而做出決策的職場環境中，其他藥師則自視為為社區提供寶貴服務：「我不太同意產業中許多倫理規範 [藥房]。我知道這是不可避免的，但從他人的健康中獲利從來不是我最看重的」（一位 30 歲的女性）。

特定藥房領域的重要性亦受家庭背景、性別及族群議題的影響。小型藥房事業常由家族世代相傳，進而影響人們選擇成為社區藥師的決定。一位參與者表示，家族擁有藥房事業對其職業偏好產生了影響：

> 我的父母曾經經營一家 [藥房] 店。因此，我對零售業一直很有興趣。我喜歡與患者交談並獲利。我認為社區始終是我會選擇的道路。我從一開始就知道這一點。（一位四十多歲的女性）

許多女性參與者亦報告稱，家庭壓力促使她們在社區藥房工作，特別是來自亞洲及中東背景的女性。她們描述社區藥房如何讓她們的文化中的女性有機會兼顧工作與重要的家庭責任：「我實際上受到 [家庭的] 鼓勵，在社區藥房工作。對女孩來說，在社區藥房工作較容易，晚上回家後還能照顧孩子」（一位四十歲的女性）。

最終邊界穿越係數是特定領域獲取工作的限制，尤其是產業與醫院藥房。此點在註冊前階段後尤為重要：

> 進入業界競爭相當激烈，所以我選擇了醫院。（一位三十多歲的女性）

> 我嘗試進入醫院工作，但非常困難，所以我選擇在一家小型獨立店鋪進行[預註冊] ，這是一段很好的經驗，但與在醫院工作截然不同。（一位三十多歲的女性）

地理領域與邊界

參與者所識別的最具影響力的職業邊界是地理因素。本研究中有八位參與者為了促進自己或伴侶的職業發展而遷居。跨越地理邊界的動機與職業晉升或希望居住於其他地點有關：

> 我從英國的威爾斯來到英國 [，因為我想做更多研究，而顯然我沒有時間處理所有我肩負的管理責任。（一位四十多歲的女性）

> 我改變了職業道路，因為我真的很想回紐西蘭，所以我想「試試看醫院」。(40 歲女性)

兩位參與者表示，他們有強烈的動機在明確的地理範圍內發展職業生涯。這主要源於他們偏好與居住於特定區域相關的生活方式。第一位參與者申請了倫敦一家醫院的工作，因為她「一直想住在 [t]這裡」（一位 30 多歲的女性）。第二位參與者

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took a career opportunity because she 'wanted to come back to London and Tooting was home for [her]' (Woman in her 40s).

The evidence suggested that family constraints were the most salient factor affecting geographical mobility. Participants reported how having children in school or dependent elders narrowed their career opportunities. One participant, for instance, described how his family had limited his ability to pursue career opportunities outside the London area for several years. In contrast, participants who were more geographically boundaryless pointed to the absence of family commitments for their willingness to relocate to pursue career opportunities:

> I've made the choice of where I worked based on where my family is […] when I was very young and I was at [Hospital] my father had recently died and my mother was alone so I didn't want to move too far away from her even though I had opportunities to work elsewhere. Also when my children got older I couldn't move them. (Man in his 40s)

> I'm not married or have children so I've been able to not have any ties to a geographical place. I don't have a problem moving in London or moving outside. (Woman in her 50s)

In summary, the findings have revealed that participants identified five salient domains and associated boundaries shaping the direction of their careers: occupation; the divide between work and personal/family life; organization; sector; and geography. In addition, findings showed that mobility within or across boundaries was associated with people's career preferences and with their ability to negotiate boundary crossing conditions.

Discussion and conclusion

This article aims to extend the analysis of career boundaries in the belief that this can advance career theory and improve understanding of career behaviour. Hernes (2004) suggests that the study of boundaries has sometimes been neglected in favour of a focus on the domains that they circumscribe. The popular focus on career boundarylessness also implies that boundaries may not be very important. However, Clark (2000) has argued that even if boundaries are becoming more flexible, this does not mean that they are becoming any less salient. Therefore, as a point of departure for this article, some of the critiques of the boundaryless career were revisited and it was argued that its conceptual and operational limitations stem from the way its proponents envisage career boundaries. The focus on inter-organizational career mobility and the view that career boundaries are fading and losing importance not only minimizes the intricacies with which people construe and seek to manage their careers, but also limits the usefulness of the boundaryless career concept for addressing contemporary careers. This article therefore adopts an analytic framework which focuses on career boundaries. It starts from an analysis of relevant career domains and the boundaries within and between them and identifies a range of structural and motivational factors that facilitate or inhibit boundary crossing within relevant domains.

This article supports calls to give boundaries a central role in career inquiry (Gunz et al., 2007; Inkson et al., 2012) by providing one of the first empirical studies exploring

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她抓住了一個職業機會，因為她「想回倫敦，而托丁是 [她]的家」（一位 40 多歲的女性）。

證據顯示，家庭限制是影響地理流動性最顯著的因素。參與者報告說，子女就學或需照顧的長輩縮窄了他們的職業機會。例如，一位參與者描述其家庭如何限制他數年來在倫敦地區以外追求職業機會的能力。相比之下，那些地理邊界較少限制的參與者則指出，缺乏家庭承諾使他們願意 relocate 以追求職業機會：

> 我選擇工作的地點，是基於家人所在的 [...] ，當我還很年輕時，我在 [醫院] ，父親剛去世，母親獨自一人，所以我不想離她太遠，儘管我有在其他地方工作的機會。此外，當我的孩子長大後，我也無法帶他們搬家。（一位四十多歲的男士）

> 我沒有結婚也沒有孩子，因此沒有被綁定在特定地理區域。無論是在倫敦搬遷還是搬到外地，我都不覺得有問題。（一位 50 歲的女性）

總之，研究發現參與者識別出五個顯著領域及其相關邊界，這些邊界塑造了他們的職業發展方向：職業；工作與個人/家庭生活之間的界線；組織；部門；以及地理區域。此外，研究結果顯示，在邊界內或跨邊界的流動與人們的職業偏好相關，也與他們協商邊界跨越條件的能力相關。

討論與結論

本文旨在擴展對職業邊界的分析，認為這將有助於推進職業理論並改善對職業行為的理解。Hernes (2004) 指出，對邊界的研究有時因過度關注其所界定的領域而受到忽視。對「無邊界職業」的流行關注也暗示邊界可能並不重要。然而，Clark (2000) 論述，即使邊界變得更加靈活，這並不意味著它們的重要性降低。因此，作為本文的起點，本文重新檢視了對無邊界職業的一些批評，並指出其概念與操作上的限制源於其支持者對職業邊界的構想。對組織間職業流動的關注，以及認為職業邊界正在消失並失去重要性的觀點，不僅最小化了人們如何詮釋並試圖管理其職業的複雜性，也限制了無邊界職業概念在應對當代職業問題上的實用性。因此，本文採用一種分析框架，聚焦於職業邊界。該框架從相關職業領域及其內部與之間的邊界分析開始，並識別出一系列促進或阻礙相關領域內邊界跨越的結構性與動機性因素。

本文支持將邊界賦予職業探究核心地位的主張（Gunz 等，2007；Inkson 等，2012），並提供早期探索性實證研究之一

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the range of career-relevant domains and influences on boundary crossing within these domains. The findings help to progress research beyond the duality between bounded and boundaryless careers in three ways. First, the study shows that careers are shaped by a wide range of domains and that primacy given to one specific domain limits our understanding of the way people construe careers and career opportunities. Among this sample of professional pharmacists five core career domains and associated boundaries were identified with varying degrees of frequency – occupation, work–non-work, organization, sector and geography. Nevertheless, this list is not exhaustive. For example, in a few cases, employment contract boundaries were mentioned, reflecting a preference for permanent or temporary or part-time versus full-time work. Some variation across different populations might also be expected; for example, occupation may be more important for professional workers while in some contexts sector may have limited salience.

Second, the findings indicate that people seek to manage boundaries according to their values and goals and that these motivate them either to cross or remain within career-relevant domain boundaries. This suggests that careers encompass both dimensions of boundarylessness and embeddedness. Future research may attempt to map out these patterns and provide a more fully informed perspective for understanding career decisions and contemporary career patterns. In addition, the findings show that people's ability to engage in desired patterns of career mobility/stability is dependent on their ability to negotiate boundary crossing conditions. In line with the sociological literature on careers (Greenman, 2011; Kirton, 2009), findings indicate that women, particularly those from an ethnic minority background, reported stronger career constraints that limit boundary crossing. Future research therefore needs to reconcile agency and structure and to bring together the psychological and the sociological research traditions in the study of careers.

Third, the findings contribute to broadening a research agenda on career boundaries. The evidence suggests that people construe career boundaries along dimensions such as strength and permeability. The characteristics of boundaries also seemed to be dynamic, varying according to life and career stage and pressures from various domains, including family and social background. Further research is needed to capture the key characteristics and dimensions under which people construe boundaries as well as the boundary management strategies they use to achieve desired career outcomes. In so doing it is important to take into account that successful boundary management may depend on a favourable social and economic environment. In this respect, professional pharmacists are a relatively privileged group, yet they reported a range of significant structural barriers in pursuing their career goals.

This study has certain limitations. While the choice of professional pharmacists has offered diversity in terms of access to a sample of workers with a variety of career experiences and trajectories, the boundaries identified among this group may not be generalizable to other workers. Further research with other types of workers in different contexts is therefore needed. In addition, the study's reliance on one-off interviews facilitates the emergence of post-hoc explanations about how people construe career boundaries and make career decisions. Longitudinal research is needed to capture the dynamic nature of boundaries and assess how perceptions of specific boundary characteristics shape the direction of people's careers.

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職業相關領域的範圍以及影響這些領域內邊界跨越的因素。研究結果有助於以三種方式推進超越「有界」與「無界」職業二元對立的研究。首先，該研究顯示職業受到廣泛領域的塑造，若過度強調某一特定領域，將限制我們對人們如何構建職業與職業機會的理解。在此專業藥師樣本中，識別出五個核心職業領域及其相關邊界，出現頻率各異：職業、工作與非工作、組織、部門及地理區域。然而，此列表並非完整。例如，在少數情況下，提及了僱傭合約邊界，反映出對永久、臨時或兼職與全職工作的偏好。此外，不同群體間也可能存在差異；例如，職業對專業工作者可能更為重要，而在某些情境下，部門的相關性可能較低。

其次，研究結果顯示，人們會依據其價值觀與目標來管理界線，這些因素促使他們或跨越或維持與職業相關的領域界線。這表明職業生涯同時涵蓋了無界性與嵌入性的兩個面向。未來的研究可嘗試描繪這些模式，並為理解職業決策與當代職業趨勢提供更全面的視角。此外，研究結果顯示，人們參與期望的職業流動/穩定模式的能力，取決於其協商界線跨越條件的能力。這與職業生涯的文獻（Greenman, 2011; Kirton, 2009）一致，研究結果顯示，女性，特別是來自少數族裔背景的女性，報告了較強的職業限制，這些限制阻礙了界線的跨越。因此，未來的研究需要調和主體性與結構，並將心理學與社會學的研究傳統整合於職業生涯的研究之中。

第三，這些發現有助於拓展關於職業邊界的研究議程。證據顯示，人們會依據強度與滲透性等維度來詮釋職業邊界。邊界的特性似乎也是動態的，會隨個人生命階段與職業階段，以及來自家庭與社會背景等領域的壓力而有所不同。未來研究需進一步釐清人們詮釋邊界所依據的關鍵特徵與維度，以及他們為達成期望的職業成果所採用的邊界管理策略。在此過程中，必須考慮到成功的邊界管理可能取決於有利的社會與經濟環境。就此而言，專業藥師屬於相對享有特權的群體，卻仍報告了追求職業目標時面臨的多項重大結構性障礙。

本研究存在若干限制。雖然選擇專業藥師提供了樣本多樣性，涵蓋了職業經驗與軌跡各異的勞工群體，但在此群體中辨識出的界線未必能推廣至其他勞工。因此，未來需在其他情境下針對其他類型的勞工進行進一步研究。此外，本研究依賴一次性訪談，有助於後設解釋人們如何建構職業界線並做出職業決策。未來需進行縱向研究，以捕捉界線的動態特性，並評估對特定界線特徵的認知如何影響人們職業發展的方向。

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Overall, this article highlights the usefulness of an analysis focusing on a range of domains and their boundaries to provide new insights about the way people make sense of their careers. This fuller view of career boundaries offers the possibility of progressing careers research beyond the limitations of the debate between bounded and boundaryless careers that has dominated much of the careers literature over the last 20 years and re-emphasizes the importance of recognizing a range of structural constraints on career choices. This is one of the first empirical studies of career boundaries that is, itself, not limited or bounded by a focus on the boundaryless career debate. By exploring the salience of career domains, and the motivation for and constraints on boundary crossing, this study offers a framework for further research with different occupational groups. This in turn may lead to a greater integration of boundary concepts within career thinking and pave the way for a fuller understanding of career boundaries.

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總體而言，本文強調了聚焦於多種領域及其邊界以提供關於人們如何理解其職業生涯的新見解的分析之價值。這種對職業邊界的更全面視角，使職業生涯研究得以超越過去二十年主導職業生涯文獻的「有界」與「無界」職業生涯辯論的局限，並重新強調識別多種影響職業選擇的結構性限制的重要性。這是一項關於職業邊界的首批實證研究之一，其本身亦未受或受困於對「無界」職業生涯辯論的關注。透過探討職業領域的顯著性，以及跨越邊界的動機與限制，本研究為針對不同職業群體進行進一步研究提供了框架。這將有助於將邊界概念更完整地融入職業思維，並為更全面理解職業邊界鋪平道路。

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